

A Confessional Guide

CONFESSION is the scriptural administration of God's forgiveness for specific sins. After the total remission of former sins through conversion and Baptism, the Christian should regularly have his sins blotted out through confession in order to restore the union between him or herself and God.

Several things are necessary for the making of a sincere and complete confession:

Contrition: this means true sorrow for sin. If we think of the price that Jesus had to pay for our sins we will feel the weight of them and have true repentance for them.

Repentance means "turning around to go the other way" or "returning to God." Sins are our actions and direction going in a way other than toward God. To repent is to find God again, to give up the wrong path, to honestly admitting our guilt and irresponsibility in rejection and moving away from Him, and to begin making progress again in the road of our salvation.

Confession: we must honestly confess, not withholding anything. It requires preparation, and the best confession is a written list of sins prepared with prayer that God's Holy Spirit show us all the sins we have committed—or those proper actions we have left undone—in thought, word, and deed. It requires humility, which is simply seeing things the way they are. If we pray, He will help us, and protect us from unnecessary scruples, and from fooling ourselves. As soon as possible after preparing the list you should make your confession to a priest.

Satisfaction and Amendment of Life: this step is living out your repentance, faithfully obedient to perform the penance assigned to you by your confessor, and trying both by your acts of will, and by resorting to God's grace, to avoid those sins again.

Some special guidance is needed in preparing a confession.

First, use some kind of guide for reviewing your life and assessing sins for your list, such as this guide.

Second, prepare a list by writing out, in whole sentences beginning with the word, "I," followed with the sin, perhaps an indication of frequency or time span of its occurrence, and indication briefly of who was sinned against. (Ex.: I stole money three times from my friend.)

Third, you do not need to explain the sins. There are really no adequate explanations for our misdeeds, and God is not interested in the reasons. Do not try to justify the sin.

Fourth, do not confess others' sins. Our own sins may be tied up with the sins of others, but it is not the point of confession to also explain what others have done.

And Fifth, be at peace. Embarking on a confession begins the process of restoration of your peace and assurance of God's love toward you. You will probably be making confession because you have a conscience that informs you that your sins are too great

to ignore. Your confession is the solution, so be assured that your anxiety will soon be over. Know that God truly loves you for doing this. Although we may think that He insists on seeing only those who are sinless, He has shown us through the revelation of His Son, Jesus Christ, that He is truly interested in sinners, especially when they repent, confess, and change.

Self-Examination

Recite this prayer, or words to this effect:

O HOLY SPIRIT, Source of all light, Spirit of wisdom, of understanding, and of knowledge, come to my assistance and enable me to make a good confession. Enlighten me, and help me now to know my sins as one day I shall have to recognize them at thy judgment seat. Bring to my mind the evil that I have done and the good that I have neglected. Permit me not to be blinded by self-love. Grant me, moreover, heartfelt sorrow for my transgressions, knowing how deeply they have wounded the loving Heart of my Heavenly Father; and help me to make a good and complete confession that all stain of guilt may be washed away in the Precious Blood of my Saviour Jesus Christ. Amen.

Now think about God, who made you, who gives you everything each moment for your life and for your eternal salvation, who has given you His own Son. Think about how He had to die for your sins. And think of how bad it is to follow sin, the world, and the devil instead of this Holy God.

Do not be in a hurry, and don't try to force any memories that do not come. Just be honest. Don't confess something you haven't done "just in case." You cannot be forgiven for sins you have not committed.

Write any sin down as it occurs to you, not necessarily in the words of the guide, and perhaps entirely different, as God leads you. This guide is a way to consider sin in a way we don't ordinarily do every day, and so you may have things come to mind you never thought of before. If you are not sure something you have done is sin, just write it down and ask your confessor about it at the time of your confession.

The 7 Deadly Sins

Pride

PRIDE is putting the self in the place of God as the center and object of our life, or of some part thereof. It is a refusal to recognize our status as creatures, dependent on God for our existence, which have been placed by God in a relationship to the rest of His creation. Pride is always a distortion of reality. It is the sin of Lucifer, the fallen archangel.

Here are some examples of this many-faceted sin.

Irreverence. Deliberate neglect of the worship of God every Sunday in His Church, or being content with "going through the motions" instead of truly participating with the heart and the head. Disregard and lack of participation in days of obligation or

important Holy Days, failing to take part in studies presented for our spiritual advancement, or leaving off special disciplines during fasting seasons. Failure to thank God or to express our gratitude adequately.

Disrespect for God or holy things by treating them, in thought, word, or deed, in a profane, contemptuous, or over-familiar manner. Use of holy things, such as prayers or devotions, for personal advantage, or the attempt to bribe or placate God by formulary religious practices or promises.

Sentimentality. Being satisfied with pious feelings and beautiful ceremonies with no personal commitment to serve God and obey His commands.

Presumption. Depending on self rather than on God, therefore neglecting the available means of grace—the sacraments, Bible study and prayer. Excusing ourselves from ordinary duties because we feel that we are superior persons. Satisfaction, complacency, or haughtiness over spiritual achievements. Failure to avoid, when possible, the occasion of temptation. Placing the self in the way of the devil, testing oneself to the point of sin. Preferring our own ideas, methods, and procedures. Foolish optimism.

Failure to recognize every job we are given as a divine vocation, a service to God. Unwillingness to surrender all of ourselves to Christ, for His oversight, for His sanctification, to let Him act in and through us. Going about tasks in our own strength instead of by the grace of God. Failure to offer to God regularly prayers for people or causes which we should be upholding in prayer.

Distrust. Refusal to recognize God's wisdom, providence and love. Worry, anxiety, misgivings, scrupulosity, or perfectionism. Resorting to spiritism, astrology, fortune-telling, magic, superstition, witchcraft, Ouija boards, tarot cards, or any of the occult means of divination.

Over-sensitiveness. Expectation that others will dislike, reject, or mistreat us; anticipating their negative attitudes or quickness to take offense. Unfounded suspicions.

Timidity in accepting responsibility, or cowardice in facing difficulty or suffering. Surrender to feelings of depression, gloom, pessimism, discouragement, self-pity, or fear of death, instead of fighting to be brave, cheerful and hopeful.

Disobedience. Rejection of God's known will in favor of our own opinions, interests or pleasures. Disobedience of the legitimate laws, regulations, or authority of the Church, state, marriage, parents, teachers, etc.; or else slow, reluctant obedience. Failure when in authority to fulfill responsibilities or to consider the best interests of those under us.

Refusal to learn God's nature or will as revealed in Scripture, offered in godly instruction or expert advice, or discernible through prayer, meditation or reading of orthodox religious writings. Absorption in our own affairs, leaving little time, energy or interest for the things of God.

Violation of confidence. Breaking of legitimate promises or contracts. Irresponsibility. Treachery. Unnecessary disappointment of another, or the causing of shame or anxiety to those who love us. Taking the lesser road, or accepting a minor good when the best and fullest life is offered by God for us.

Impenitence. Refusal to search out and face up to our sins, or to confess and admit them before God. Disregard of our sins or pretense that we are better than we are. Self-justification or discounting our sins as insignificant, natural or inevitable. Self-righteous comparison of ourselves with others.

Refusal to accept just punishment or to make due reparation when possible. Deceit or lying to escape the consequences of our sins. Allowing another to suffer the blame for our faults. Overcompensation or attempts at self-reform, or self-vengeance, to avoid surrender to God in humble penitence.

Shame (hurt pride), sorrow for ourselves because our sins make us less respectable than we like to think we are, or because we fear punishment or injury to our reputation, rather than sorrow for what our sins are in the eyes of God. Refusal to admit we were in the wrong, or at least part of the problem, and apologize. Refusal to accept forgiveness from God or others. Doubt that God can forgive our sins. Failure to use confession and absolution to assure us of His forgiveness when we need it. Unwillingness to forgive ourselves.

Vanity. Giving ourselves—not God—credit for our talents, abilities, insights, accomplishments, good works. Refusal to admit our indebtedness to others, or adequately express gratitude for their help. Hypocrisy. Pretense to virtues we do not possess. False humility. Harsh judgments on others for faults we excuse in ourselves.

Boasting, exaggerating, drawing attention to ourselves by talking too much, by claiming ability, wisdom, experience or influence we do not have, or by eccentric or ostentatious behavior. Undue concern over, or too much expenditure of time, money, or energy on looks, dress, surroundings, possessions, etc., in order to impress others. Deliberate slovenliness for the same purpose. Seeking, desiring or relishing flattery or compliments.

Arrogance. Insisting that others conform to our wishes, recognize our leadership, accept our own estimate of our worth. Being overbearing, argumentative, opinionated, obstinate. Cutting into another's conversation, or finishing sentences for others.

Snobbery. Pride over race, family, position, personality, education, skill, achievements, or possessions.

Anger

ANGER is open rebellion against God or our fellow creatures. Its purpose and desire is to eliminate any obstacle to our self-seeking, to retaliate against any threat to our security, to avenge any insult or injury to our person or invasion into what we see as our world.

Resentment. Refusal to discern, accept or fulfill God's vocation for us. Dissatisfaction with the talents, abilities or opportunities He has given to us. Unwillingness to face up to difficulties or sacrifices. Unjustified rebellion or complaint at the circumstances of our lives. Escape from reality, or the attempt to force our will upon it. Transference to God, to our parents, to society, or to other individuals of the blame for our maladjustment. Hatred of God. Antisocial behavior. Cynicism. Annoyance at the contrariness of things. Profanity. Grumbling.

Pugnacity. Attack upon another in anger. Murder in deed or desire. Combativeness or nursing of grudges. Injury to another by striking, cursing or insulting him; or by damaging his reputation or property. Quarrelsomeness, bickering, contradiction, nagging, rudeness, or snubbing.

Retaliation. Vengeance for wrongs real or imagined, or the plotting thereof. Harsh or excessive punishment. Hostility, sullenness or rash judgment. Refusal to forgive, or to offer or accept reconciliation. Unwillingness to love, to do good to, or to pray for enemies. Boycotting or ostracizing another for selfish reasons. Spoiling others' pleasure by uncooperativeness or disdain, because we have not got our way, or because we feel out of sorts or superior.

Envy

ENVY is dissatisfaction with our place in God's order of creation, manifested in begrudging His gifts and vocations to others.

Contempt. Offense at the talents, success or good fortune of others. Scorn of another's virtue, ability, shortcomings, or failings. Prejudice against those we consider inferior, or who seem to threaten our security or position. Ridicule of persons, institutions or ideals. Pleasure at others' difficulties or distress. Belittling others.

Malice. Ill-will, false accusations, slander, backbiting. Reading false motives into others' behavior. Initiating or retelling of gossip. Arousing or fostering antagonism against others. Unnecessary criticism, even when true. Deliberate annoyance of others, teasing or bullying.

Jealousy. Selfish or unnecessary rivalry or competition. Undue possessiveness of relationships, possession, or position in life. Guardedness and suspicion of others' motives, friendship or constructive criticisms.

Covetousness

COVETOUSNESS is the refusal to respect the integrity of other creatures, expressed in the inordinate accumulation of material things; in the use of others for our personal advantage; or in the quest for status, power or security at others' expense.

Inordinate Ambition. Pursuit of status, power, influence, reputation, or possessions at the expense of the moral law, of other obligations, or of the rights of others. Ruthless or unfair competition. Putting self or family first. Conformity to standards we recognize as wrong or inadequate in order to get ahead. Intrigue or conspiracy for self-advancement.

Domination. Seeking to use or possess others. Overprotection of children. Refusal to correct or punish children lest we lose their affection. Insistence that they conform to our ideals for them contrary to their own vocation. Imposing our will on others by force, guile, whining, or refusal to cooperate. Over-readiness to advise or command. Abuse of authority. Patronizing, pauperizing, putting others under a debt of gratitude, or considering ourselves ill-used when others' affection or compliance is not for sale. Abortion of our unborn children due to what we feel are financial or social pressures.

Respect of persons, favoritism, partiality, flattery, fawning, or bribery to win support or affection. Refusal to uphold the truth, fulfill duties, perform good acts, or defend those wrongfully attacked because we fear criticism or ridicule, or because we seek to gain favor or approval of others. Leading, tempting or encouraging another to sin.

Avarice. Inordinate pursuit of wealth or material things. Theft, dishonesty, misrepresentation, or sharing in stolen goods. Cheating in business, taxes, school or games. Making worldly success the goal of our life or the standard for judging others.

Prodigality. Waste of natural resources or personal possessions. Extravagance or living beyond our means, to impress others or maintain our status. Failure to pay our debts. Gambling, especially more than we can afford to lose, or to win unearned profits. Unnecessary borrowing or carelessness with others' money. Expenditure on self of what is needed for the welfare of others.

Penuriousness. Undue protection of wealth or security. Selfish insistence on vested interests or on claimed rights. Receiving usury. Refusal to support or help those who have a legitimate claim on us. Sponging on others. Stinginess. Failure to give due proportion, as in the tithe, of our income to Church and charity, or of our time to good works. Failure to pay pledges promised to the Church or charities when able to do so.

Gluttony

GLUTTONY is the overindulgence of natural appetites for food and drink, and by extension the inordinate quest for pleasure or comfort.

Intemperance. Overindulgence in food, drink, smoking, or other physical pleasures, especially those which are of an unhealthy nature. Use of illegal substances, or abuse of prescription medicines.

Fastidiousness, fussiness, demanding excessively high standards, or dilettantism. Condemnation of some material things or pleasures as evil in themselves, attempting to prohibit their use rather than their abuse.

Lack of Discipline. Negligence in keeping the days of fasting or abstinence, of failure to use other good means of self-discipline. Neglect of bodily health—not getting sufficient rest, recreation, exercise, or wholesome nourishment. Failure to use or to cooperate with available medical care when ill. Use of sickness as a means of escape from responsibilities.

Lust

LUST is the misuse of sex for personal gratification, debasing it from the holy purpose for which God has given it to us.

Unchastity. Violation of the Church's marriage laws. Lack of consideration for one's partner in married relationship. Refusal to fulfill the purpose of Holy Matrimony in the bringing forth and giving adequate care to children, or to take our full share in the responsibilities or work involved. Unfaithfulness to one's spouse (adultery) by engaging in sexual conduct or fantasies with others. Sexual indulgence outside matrimony, in thought or act, alone or with others. Sodomy, or using sexual things in an unnatural way.

Immodesty. Stimulation of sexual desire in others by word, dress or actions; or in oneself by reading, pictures, or fantasies. Reading, hearing and recounting of dirty stories.

Prudery. Fear of sex or condemnation of it as evil in itself. Refusal to seek adequate sexual counsel or the attempt to prevent others from obtaining it. Stimulation of excessive and harmful curiosity by undue secrecy. Repression.

Cruelty. Deliberate infliction of pain or fear, mental or physical. Rape. Incest. Tormenting animals.

Sloth

SLOTH is the refusal to respond to our opportunities for growth, service or sacrifice.

Laziness. Indolence in performing spiritual, mental or physical duties, or neglect of family, business or social obligations or courtesies. Procrastination of disliked tasks. Busyness or triviality to avoid more important commitments. Devotion of excessive time to rest, recreation, amusement, television, light reading or other entertainment. Waste of employer's time, or shoddy and inadequate work.

Indifference. Lack of concern over injustice to others, even that caused by currently accepted social standards; unmindfulness of suffering in the world. Failure to become adequately informed on both sides of contemporary issues or on the Christian principles involved. Neglect of duties to state or community. Failure to provide adequately for, or to treat justly those in our employ.

Ignoring the needy, lonely or unpopular persons in our own or in the parish family, or our neighborhood; and unwillingness to minister to them. Insufficient attention to the religious and other needs of our family. Failure to fulfill our obligation of Christian missionary witness, or to take a full and informed part in the effort to make the Church's unity and holiness a manifest reality on earth.

In case the suggestions contained in the 7 Deadly Sins do not trigger your memory sufficiently, or they don't fit your concept of God's commandments, consider as well the following suggested sins, arranged by the Ten Commandments:

The 10 Commandments.

1. "Thou shalt have none other gods but me."

PRIDE: an exaggerated view of myself, and too small a view of God.

Have you put yourself before God in any ways? Have you always tried to be first? Are you unduly concerned about your appearance, clothes, achievements? Do you make fun of others for their weaknesses?

Do you talk too much, call attention to yourself? Are you sorry for yourself? Have you refused to admit when you were wrong? Are you stubborn?

Have you loved the Lord your God with all your heart, and with all your mind, and with all your strength? (See **PRIDE** in the 7 Deadly Sins above).

2. "Thou shalt not make idols and worship them."

IDOLATRY: putting anything else in your life before God.

Have you put any other person before the will of God? Have you failed to attend church for someone or something else? Have you sinned to please someone? Have you wanted popularity so much that you have not said prayers, or you have denied that you love and believe in God?

Do you love money, clothes, toys, or anything too much? Have you engaged in any practice of another religion, or occult practices (Ouija Boards, Tarot cards, fortune telling)?

3. "Thou shalt not take the Name of God in vain."

PROFANITY: using your mouth to say what is not God's will.

Have you used swear language or dirty words? Have you used God's Name as a curse?

Have you been anxious instead of turning to God for help, failing to speak to Him? Have you been worried, afraid, panicked? Have you felt that God was not interested to help you?

Have you presented yourself as a Christian, in His Name, and then acted in a way that brought discredit to God?

4. "Remember that thou keep holy the Sabbath day."

IRREVERENCE: failing to give God worship when He requires it.

Have you missed church because you were tired or lazy? Have you been too lazy to pray morning and night? Do you say prayers in a way that you really don't mean them? Do you have a godly attitude about Sunday? Holy Days?

Have you kept your attention on God while in church? Have you made jokes about God, about Jesus, about church? Have you ever felt ashamed of Jesus, of Christianity?

5. "Honor thy father and mother."

DISOBEDIENCE: failing to obey those in authority over you.

Have you been thankful for good things you have received from parents? Did you ever willfully disobeyed your parent's righteous request of you? Have you ever disobeyed God's will for you? What ways? Have you ever broken or shown disregard for laws? Have you given your parents, teachers, pastors, and other adults your best ability, your thanks, your attention all the time? Have you neglected grace before meals? Have you attended Sunday School as often as you could? Have you tried to be the boss when it is not your position to be one?

6. "Thou shalt do no murder."

ANGER: See Anger in the 7 Deadly Sins.

7. "Thou shalt not commit adultery."

IMPURITY: giving your mind or body to the wrong things.

Have you been impure in thought, word or deed? Have you looked at bad pictures? Have you seen movies that were too sexy? Have you ever eaten too much, drunk alcohol, smoked anything, or taken illegal drugs?

Have you watched TV when you should have been studying? Watched TV just to have something to do? (See LUST above).

8. "Thou shalt not steal."

THEFT: taking what is not yours.

Have you ever stolen anything? What? Have you shared in something another person stole? Have you cheated in school or at games? Have you gambled?

Have you given back to God what is His, namely the tithe? Are you stingy? cheap? Have you wasted time?

9. "Thou shalt not bear false witness."

DECEIT: lying about anything, particularly to take advantage or to hurt another.

How many lies have you told? Have you exaggerated about things? Have you been unfair? Have you let others take the blame for what you did? Have you tried to get another person in trouble? Have you felt happy when someone else was punished?

10. "Thou shalt not covet."

DISCONTENT: feeling that you don't have all that you should have.

Have you been envious about what others have, or the talents they have? Are you jealous of the appearance of others? of their homes? their possessions? Have you felt sad that someone else had attained a position you felt they didn't deserve? Have you been angry or dejected because you saw someone who had what you don't have?

Are you often sad about your life? your possessions? your self? Do you sometimes think that God has forgotten you or doesn't love you? Have you given up trying to be good?

[The Summary of the Law](#)

THE LAW OF LOVE

One day a lawyer, trying to trap Jesus in an unorthodox answer, asked Him what the greatest of the Law was. Jesus' answer was:

"Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind. This is the first and great commandment. And the second is like unto it; Thou shalt love thy neighbor as thyself. On these two commandments hang all the Law and the Prophets."

If we understand the Law of Love, how much we must love God and how completely, no one can boast that he has fulfilled it. We must, therefore, always confess our failure to love God with all that we are, even though that is His standard. We must also confess, as much as is applicable, our failure to love our neighbor, meaning everyone, as much as we love ourselves.

Prayer after Self-Examination

Say these prayers, or prayers much like this, after you have completed the task of listing your sins on paper:

O my God, how great are my sins! Would that I had never offended Thee. If by carelessness or ignorance I have forgotten anything in my self-examination, show it to me now that I may make a good and complete confession. Amen.

O my God, I cry unto thee with the prodigal: Father, I have sinned against heaven, and before Thee, and am no more worthy to be called Thy son, (or Thy daughter). But now, O God, give me true sorrow of heart for my many sins whereby I have grieved Thee, and enable me to make a full confession to Thy priest, that I may receive perfect remission of them, through Thine infinite goodness. Amen.

O God, I am very sorry that I have sinned against Thee who art so good. Forgive me for Jesus' sake, and I will try to sin no more. Amen.

O God, I love Thee with my whole heart and above all things and am heartily sorry that I have offended Thee. May I never offend Thee any more. Oh, may I love Thee without ceasing, and make it my delight to do in all things Thy most holy will. Amen.

[Making your Confession](#)

You then make this confession at the appointed time with your confessor. Kneel down and begin by saying:

Bless me Father, for I have sinned.

Priest: The Lord be in thy heart and upon thy lips, that so thou mayest worthily confess all thy sins; In the Name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

Then say:

I CONFESS to God Almighty, the Father, Son and Holy Ghost, to all the saints and all the company of heaven, and to you, Father, that I have sinned exceedingly in thought, word, deed and omission, by my fault, by my own fault, by my own most grievous fault. Since my last confession which was ___ ago, when I received absolution and performed my prescribed penance, I have committed the following sins:

Then, without explanations or excuses, read aloud the list you have prepared, and anything else that may come to mind, leaving nothing out, and being sure to name yourself as the one who committed the sins. Tell them, to God Himself, with a sorrowful and contrite heart.

When you have finished telling your sins, say:

FOR THESE and all my other sins which I cannot now remember, I am truly sorry. I firmly purpose amendment, humbly asking of God pardon and forgiveness, with grace to lead a better life. Wherefore, I beseech God to have mercy on me, through the merits and mediation of our Lord Jesus Christ. And of you, Father, I ask for penance, advice and absolution. Amen.

The priest will then spend some time with you, counseling you in your life with God and how you might avoid further occasions of sin. After this, he will prescribe a “penance” for you, a small act of devotion—the reading of a psalm or prayer, with meditation on the great gift of forgiveness that God has truly granted us. Then he will pronounce absolution in a form such as:

ALMIGHTY GOD have mercy upon thee, forgive thee thy sins, and bring thee to everlasting life. Amen.

THE ALMIGHTY AND MERCIFUL LORD grant thee pardon, absolution and remission of thy sins. Amen.

OUR LORD JESUS CHRIST, who hath left power to his Church to absolve all sinners who truly repent and believe in him, of His great mercy forgive thee thine offenses: And by His authority committed unto me, I absolve thee from all thy sins, In the Name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

MAY THE PASSION of our Lord Jesus Christ make whatsoever good thou hast done, or evil thou hast endured, be unto thee for the forgiveness of sins, the increase of grace, and the reward of eternal life: And the blessing of God Almighty, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost, be upon thee and remain with thee always. Amen.

NOW GO IN PEACE, the Lord hath put away all thy sins.
And remember to pray for me also, a sinner.

Go into the Church or a suitable quiet place and perform the penance prescribed for you right away. Do not put it off! Take as much time as you need in order to truly feel you have finished this matter with God.

Trust that God forgives us when we confess to Him like this. Remember:

“THIS THEN is the message which we have heard of him, and declare unto you, that God is light, and in him is no darkness at all. If we say that we have fellowship with him, and walk in darkness, we lie, and do not the truth: But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship one with another, and the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanseth us from all sin. If we say that we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us. If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness. If we say that we have not sinned, we make him a liar, and his word is not in us.” 1 John 1:5-10

Thank God, in prayers such as these:

I THANK THEE, my God, for giving me the forgiveness of my sins, through the Precious Blood of Jesus Christ my Savior. Bless the Lord, O my soul, and all that is within me, bless His holy Name.

O MOST MERCIFUL GOD, who in forgiving our sins, rememberest them no more against us forever, accept my unworthy thanks for thy great goodness in blotting out my transgressions. Let the grace of this absolution strengthen and sustain me, and may the pitifulness of Thy great mercy defend me evermore from all assaults of the enemy.
Amen.